Problem Statement:

- Understanding Gen Z's career choices, which are influenced by multiple factors including rapid changes in digital innovations, family dynamics, personal interests, and educational modifications *(or unfocused online studies*), using the 5W1H framework.

Introduction:

- As a matter of fact, Gen Z *(People born between 1997 and 2012)* are the future of our community and workplace. As a researcher, this particular thing drew my interest, as this is the very first generation born completely in the digital era and has a totally different attitude toward professional life.
- Also, they are expected to create a great impact on the current workforce with their creativity, passion for smart work, and tech-savviness.
- This generation has greater adaptability to new technology and unmatched digital literacy.
- This documentation focuses on Gen Z career expectations and choices, as well as providing insight to employers, policymakers, educators, and other stakeholders to effectively provide direction and help to meet Gen Z needs using the 5W1H framework*(What, Why, When, Where, Who, and How)*.

Personal Experience:

- As a career-aspiring individual and part of Gen Z, I often engage with Gen Z pupils, which helps me observe their career perspectives firsthand and reduces the generational gap.
- In my interactions, I noticed a strong desire among individuals for flexibility in their jobs and a straightforward aim/goal toward the work given. Undergoing the same things myself, such as structured, guided in-class studies versus unguided pre- recorded or unguided online studies, provides me with a unique connecting/empathetic perspective.
- This dual role as both an observer and a counterpart better helps me to analyze how rapid innovations and technical shifts directly shape our career objectives.

5W1H Framework:

What: *Factors affecting career choice*

- **Rapid Technological shifts** (The advancement of AI), due to which employers are aiming for professional or experienced individuals who can do advanced tasks that can't be fulfilled by AI. While Gen Z needs an opportunity to become an experienced person. This is increasing the gap between the current workers who already got such

opportunities or are at the senior level and those who recently graduated and are still looking for jobs in order to gain such experience to compete.

- **Change in the education system**: Due to COVID, a majority of this generation faced a shift in the education system, such as classroom studies to online pre-recorderd self studies without any guidance. This also affected their social skills, including soft skills. Which most employers look for in professional settings.
- **No clear goal**: Gen Z do not have a clear vision for their career. From my interview with Gen Z and senior employees, I found out that Gen Z do not have a clear goal; they are just looking for jobs with multiple applications and positions and are ready to work towards any field once they get an opportunity, while I noticed that millennials had a clear goal or path during their early job search, which help them stay more focued and contribute really well to their work. This is also impacting the work expectations of employers.
- **Culture Differences:** Due to the extensive availability of the Internet and social media all the time at their fingertips, this generation has a great opportunity to meet people all around the world and gain knowledge and respect for individual cultures, also adapting to different cultures and, as a result, looking for a shift in their work culture accordingly, which would be beneficial for employers for worldwide customers support. But no doubt such tools are also reducing the individual focus toward the dedicated task, as all they see on such platforms is young ones having their own millionaire business, or a fake but very luxurious lifestyle, which all sound effortless and achievable compared to the actual reality.

When

- The study will be conducted in August 2026 and will be completed by six months February, 2027. Including data gathering via social media votes, anonymous forms, and in-person interviews with Gen Z, educators, policymakers, stakeholders, and employers.

Why

- Understanding the future workforce requirements is crucial, as companies are struggling to attract them to work for them, and if such circumstances continue to persist, there would be a crisis of workers. This research will allow individuals to understand each other's perspectives and needs in an agreeable way.
- **Shift in career choice**: Certain paths may be more attractive to Gen Z due to ease and alignment with their unique preferences, flexibility, innovation, and opportunity to do creative work.

Who

- The analysis targets individuals born between 1997 and 2012, including students, early job seekers, and individuals looking for a career switch.
- **Gen Z's perspective**: Gen Z's perspective is highly driven by peers, family, educators, and social media influencers. Guidance and proper support from such individuals will

assist in making better choices. Also, with such guidance, they can get exposure to various career path and select the best one or a few for themself to thrive and perform well compared to one who accepts any open opportunity and then learns and survives.

- **Education system**: The changes as per the education system to align with actual industrial skills or knowledge requirements will also help the approaching generation to the workforce to better understand and compete for their advancement and acquire the objective they are aiming for without getting off track or distracted.

Where

- Research will be conducted primarily in Canada, focusing on college students, working individuals, employers, policymakers, hiring managers, and stakeholders, using online surveys and in-person interviews to understand each individual's perspective towards the career choice shifts and differences of Gen Z.

How

- Data will be collected using online forms and in-person interviews with a structured set of questionnaires to understand individual personal values and interests steering career decisions, with around 70 to 80 participants. Analysis will include graphs, documentation, data cleaning, and data visualization.

Conclusion:

In Conclusion, understanding the career choice of Gen Z requires looking outside traditional workplace expectations and adopting their unique individuality as digital natives. By combining personal observation and research, this documentation aims to reduce the gap between Gen Z's expectations and workplace opportunities. This understanding can help employers and educators to shape the traditional structure according to the new demands and reduce the increasing gap.